

# L'UDMILA PAJDUŠÁKOVÁ

slovak astronomer  
1916–1979

**L'**udmila Pajdušáková began her career as an observatory technician. As she set up and repaired equipment and helped astronomers analyze their observations, L'udmila became fascinated by the meteors and comets that could be spotted streaking across the night sky. She started studying astronomy in her spare time and became the first female astronomer in her country.

World War II had recently ended, and governments around the world were now racing to explore space. L'udmila and her team of four other astronomers won funding for a careful comet-hunting mission. For years, they spent their nights taking turns searching the sky.

*L'udmila's comets were discovered using a pair of giant binoculars rather than a telescope!*

*The Skalnaté Pleso Observatory is high in the mountains, where the skies are dark and clear.*

